

HYPOCREALES

The fungi in this order are usually distinguished by their brightly coloured, spore-producing structures. These are usually yellow, orange, or red. The Hypocreales are often parasitic on other fungi and also on insects.

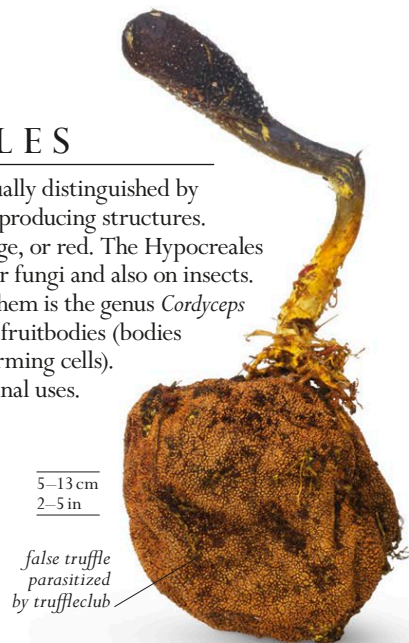
The best known among them is the genus *Cordyceps* with club- or branch-like fruitbodies (bodies that support the spore-forming cells). Some species have medicinal uses.



3–6 cm
1¼–2¼ in

SCARLET CATERPILLAR CLUB
Cordyceps militaris
F: Cordycipitaceae

Found in Eurasia and N. America, this fungus is parasitic on moth pupae. The head of its club bears tiny spore-producing structures.



5–13 cm
2–5 in

false truffle
parasitized
by truffleclub

SNAKETONGUE TRUFFLECLUB
Tolypocladium ophioglossoides
F: Ophiocordycipitaceae

Parasitic on buried false truffles, this species is found in Eurasia and N. America. It forms yellow clubs with an elongated, greenish black head.



rounded,
cushion-like
fruitbodies

CORAL SPOT
Nectria cinnabarina
F: Nectriaceae

Abundant on damp wood in Eurasia and N. America, this fungus forms pink “pimples” when sexually immature and red-brown clusters when mature.



1.5 cm
½ in

ERGOT

Claviceps purpurea
F: Clavicipitaceae
This species has caused outbreaks of mass poisoning. Found in Eurasia and N. America, it is parasitic on grass and cereal crops.



purple
ergot on
flowerheads

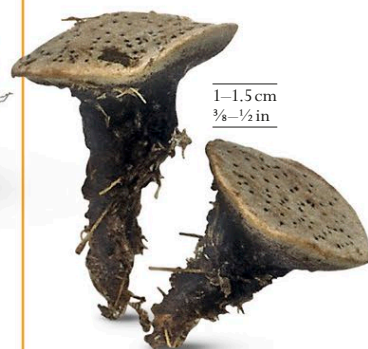
infected
bolete
fruitbody

BOLETE EATER

Hypomyces chrysospermus
F: Hypocreaceae
This common mould, found in N. America and Eurasia on bolete, turns bright golden yellow, with a fluffy texture.

XYLARIAIALES

Members of this order often have their spore-producing cells in chambers, which are embedded in a woody growth called stroma. Although many species live on wood, some also occur on animal dung, fruit, leaves, and soil, or are associated with insects. The order includes many economically important plant parasites.



1–1.5 cm
¾–½ in

NAIL FUNGUS

Poronia punctata
F: Xylariaceae

Found on horse dung in Eurasia and N. America, this species is in decline. Its flattened disc has numerous tiny holes from which spores are released.



0.5–1 cm
¼–¾ in

BEECH WOODWART

Hypoxyton fragiforme
F: Xylariaceae

Occurring in clusters on beech logs, this European and N. American species forms hard, rounded fruitbodies with tiny spore-releasing chambers.



1–4 cm
¾–1½ in

CANDLESNUFF FUNGUS

Xylaria hypoxylon
F: Xylariaceae

Common on dead wood in Eurasia and N. America, this species resembles a snuffed-out candle with a velvety black stem.

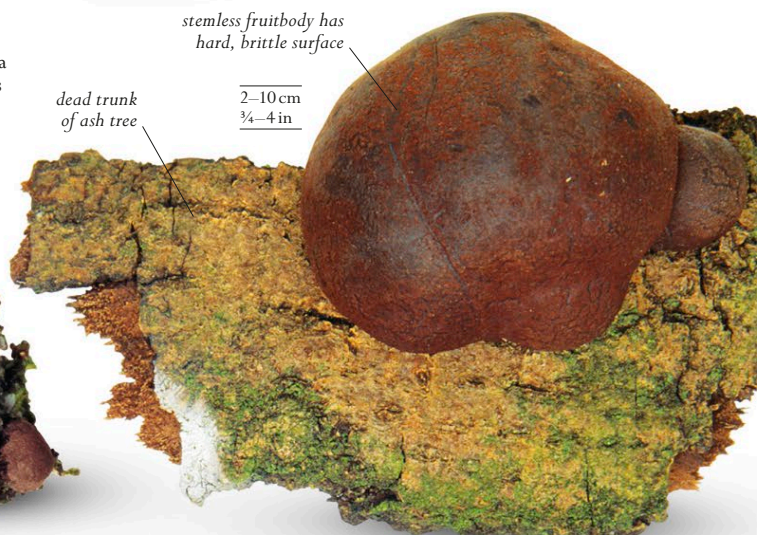


2–8 cm
¾–3¼ in

DEAD MAN'S FINGERS

Xylaria polymorpha
F: Xylariaceae

Growing on dead wood in Eurasia and N. America, this fungus forms brittle black clubs with a rough surface, tiny pores, and thick, white flesh.



stemless fruitbody has
hard, brittle surface

2–10 cm
¾–4 in

CRAMP BALLS

Daldinia concentrica
F: Xylariaceae

Found in Eurasia and N. America, this fungus has rounded fruitbodies that reveal concentric whitish zones when cut in half. They eject black spores from their outer layer.

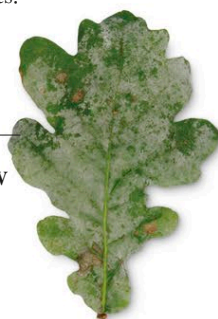
ERYSIPHALES

Parasitic on leaves and fruit of flowering plants, the Erysiphales are powdery mildews. The hyphae (filaments) of their mycelium (vegetative part of the fungus) penetrate the cells of the host plant and take up nutrients.

OAK POWDERY MILDEW

Erysiphe alphitoides
F: Erysiphaceae

Growing on oaks in Eurasia and N. America, this fungus covers young leaves, causing them to shrivel and blacken.



felt-like white mycelium
covers leaf surface



affected
apple leaf

APPLE POWDERY MILDEW

Podosphaera leucotricha
F: Erysiphaceae

Common on apple leaves in Eurasia and N. America, this mildew appears first on the underside of leaves as whitish patches, before spreading rapidly.



mildew
patches

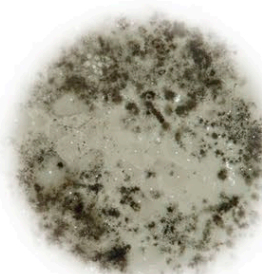
POWDERY MILDEW

Golovinomyces cichoracearum
F: Erysiphaceae

Found in Eurasia and N. America, this species appears on members of Asteraceae (the sunflower family), causing patches on leaves, which eventually die.

CAPNODIALES

Commonly called sooty moulds, these sac fungi are frequently found on leaves. They feed on the honeydew excreted by insects or on liquid exuded from the leaves. Some cause skin problems in humans.



CLADOSPORIUM CLADOSPORIOIDES

Cladosporium cladosporioides
F: Davidiellaceae

This mould, common in Eurasia and N. America, grows on damp bathroom walls. It may cause an allergic reaction in some people.